CHAPTER 3 :

TECHNICAL SUPPORT

In the world of Marvel heroes, few approach Tony Stark's level of creative genius. Of all minds, his is the most brilliant. He did, after all, assemble the Mark I Iron Man armor in a cave from a box of scraps. To create such an astonishing invention at gunpoint further illustrates his incredible resourcefulness.

But even Tony can't do it alone. While the rest of us can only fantasize about taking care of routine tasks with duplicates of ourselves, or having our needs tended to and lives made easier by robot helpers, Tony has actually been able to create such wonders.

This chapter highlights a few of the wonders brought to life by the innovative Tony Stark. First and foremost, meet Jarvis, a virtual-reality butler that has the run of the blindingly opulent Stark Estate. If Pepper Potts is Tony's right-hand gal, Jarvis holds court as his wryly enthusiastic sidekick. With an omnipresent voice hovering over the action inside Tony's domain, this cutting-edge, artificially intelligent computer has has tenure as lab assistant, tech support and – sadly – confidant to a genius too often trapped inside the contemplative isolation of his own mind.

And Tony's army of robotic helpers, in the form of Dummy and You – a pair of smart machines designed by the wunderkind teen while he was an undergraduate at MIT – represent early incarnations of Tony's Jarvis tech. Abidingly loyal, Dummy and You have served their oftentimes irascible boss through tasks as simple as handing him a screwdriver or as critical as saving his life with a timely assist – not to mention always anticipating the need to put out a fire in the Workshop.

Tony's tech support needs are further met by the ultra-advanced Heads Up Display (HUD) that allows him to interface with his armor. Controlled in tandem with Jarvis, the HUD helps Tony calculate flight paths, control his repulsor technology and perform humble tasks like evading missiles fired by fighter jets.

These kinds of details were crucial for *Iron Man* designers to get right. Their mission was to bring life to these artificial constructs – and in so doing, enable the seamless storytelling for which *Iron Man* has come to be lauded.

